EVOLUTION, 1962–65

Jolted by the 1962 setback, the Indian Army launched its first five-year plan in 1964 with the aim to raise ten mountain divisions. On 1 May 1963, HQ Central Command was established at Lucknow, with HQ Eastern Command moving to Calcutta. The raising of one additional armoured division and six more infantry divisions was proposed, as was the raising of two battalions of scouts for patrolling the Indo-Tibet border, along with the procurement of a new mountain gun and a lighter mortar for use in high-altitude areas. Existing mountain artillery regiments were reorganized as composite regiments with one heavy-mortar and three howitzer batteries. Additional mountain-composite and light-artillery regiments were raised for the new mountain divisions being formed. It was also decided to accelerate the indigenous production of equipment and standardize logistics, and to replace the 3.7in howitzer in service with the 75mm pack howitzer.

Not all of these proposals were implemented before India went to war against Pakistan in 1965. On 1 April 1965, HQ I Corps was established at Mathura in Uttar Pradesh. By mid-1965, the Indian Army had ten infantry divisions (3, 7, 10, 11, 14, 15, 19, 23, 25 and 26), ten mountain divisions (2, 4, 5, 6, 8, 9, 17, 20, 27 and 57), one armoured division (1) and one independent armoured brigade (2), with over 745,000 personnel. India's 720 tanks and 16 armoured regiments faced Pakistan's 765 tanks and 17 armoured regiments, though the Indian Army as a whole included 98 regiments, compared to the Pakistan Army's 48.